EXOTICA | maurilait

MARKET INTELLIGENCE REPORT 2026

Mauritius Dairy & FMCG Price Intelligence Market Research

A comprehensive analysis of the Mauritian dairy market, competitive landscape, pricing dynamics, digital transformation, and the strategic case for real-time price monitoring — backed by 100+ verified data points.

PREPARED BY	DATE	VERSION	CLASSIFICATION
Exotica Agency	April 2026	1.0	Confidential

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Executive Summary

Key metrics and findings that define the opportunity for price intelligence in the Mauritius dairy market.

US$454M

Mauritius Dairy Market (2024)

Growing at 5.13% CAGR, projected to reach US$583.8M by 2029. Dairy & eggs represent a major consumer spend category.

96-98%

Import Dependency

Mauritius produces only 2-4% of its milk needs locally. Rs 2 billion spent annually on dairy imports, 80% from New Zealand & Australia.

25%

Food Share of Household Spend

Average Mauritian household spends Rs 10,480/month on food — the single largest expenditure category. Consumers are acutely price-sensitive.

9.2%

Peak Food Inflation (2025)

Food prices spiked to 9.2% YoY in mid-2025, with 30% rupee depreciation since 2020 amplifying import costs. Now moderating to 3.5%.

US$1.41B

Global Price Intelligence Market

Growing at 16.2% CAGR to US$4.28B by 2033. Companies report 10-100x ROI from price monitoring tools.

11%

Margin Impact of 1% Price Improvement

In FMCG, a 1% improvement in pricing translates to an 11% improvement in margins — the single most powerful profitability lever.

CORE THESIS

Mauritius is a **US$454 million dairy market** that imports **96-98%** of its milk requirements, where food accounts for **25% of household spending** and the rupee has depreciated **30% since 2020**. In this environment, real-time price intelligence is not a luxury — it is a **competitive necessity**. Maurilait, as market leader with 150+ product references across 4 major brands, stands to gain the most from deploying systematic price monitoring across all 12 districts and 5 outlet types.

SECTION 02

Mauritius Economic & Market Landscape

Understanding the macroeconomic forces shaping consumer purchasing behavior and pricing dynamics.

Key Economic Indicators

INDICATOR	VALUE	SOURCE
Population (2026)	1,265,059	*Worldometer*
Median Age	38.3 years	*Worldometer*
GDP (2025)	US$15.73 billion	*IMF*
GDP Per Capita (2025)	US$12,519	*Trading Economics*
Real GDP Growth (2024)	4.7%	*IMF*
Real GDP Growth (2025 est.)	3.0 - 3.2%	*IMF*
Overall Inflation (Feb 2026)	3.5%	*Trading Economics*

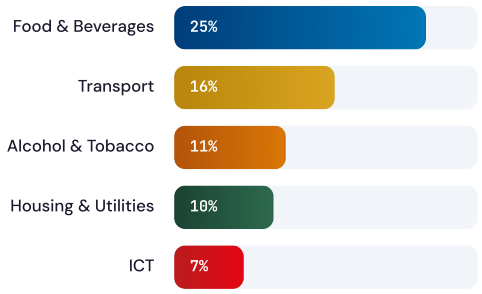
INDICATOR	VALUE	SOURCE
Food Inflation Peak (Jun 2025)	9.2% YoY	*Trading Economics*
Economic Classification	Upper-Middle Income	*Trade.gov*
Consumer Spending (2025)	Rs 618.7 billion	*IMF (+6.7% YoY)*
Food Self-Sufficiency Ratio	~25%	*Trade.gov*
Debt-to-GDP (2023)	79.7%	*AfDB*

Household Expenditure (2023 HBS)

Household Income & Spending

Avg Monthly Disposable Income	Rs 55,600
Avg Monthly Consumption	Rs 41,870
Avg Monthly Food Spend	Rs 10,480
Real Income Growth (2017-2023)	▲+22.4%
Avg Household Size	3.2
Per Capita Food Spend (2024)	US$3,370

Spending Breakdown



Source: Statistics Mauritius — Household Budget Survey 2023

INFLATION NARRATIVE

Mauritius experienced a **sharp food inflation spike to 9.2%** in mid-2025, driven by rupee depreciation (30% since 2020) and global commodity price increases. While overall inflation has moderated to 3.5% by February 2026, the structural vulnerability remains: Mauritius imports **75% of all food consumed**, making the island uniquely exposed to global price shocks and currency movements. For a dairy processor importing 96-98% of raw materials, price monitoring is existential.

SECTION 03

Mauritius Dairy Market Deep Dive

A US$454 million market with near-total import dependency and growing consumer demand.

US$454.5M

Market Revenue (2024)

Dairy Products & Eggs. Includes milk, yogurt, cheese, eggs, and substitutes.

5.13%

CAGR (2024-2029)

Projected to reach US$583.8M by 2029 driven by premiumization and new categories.

122 kg

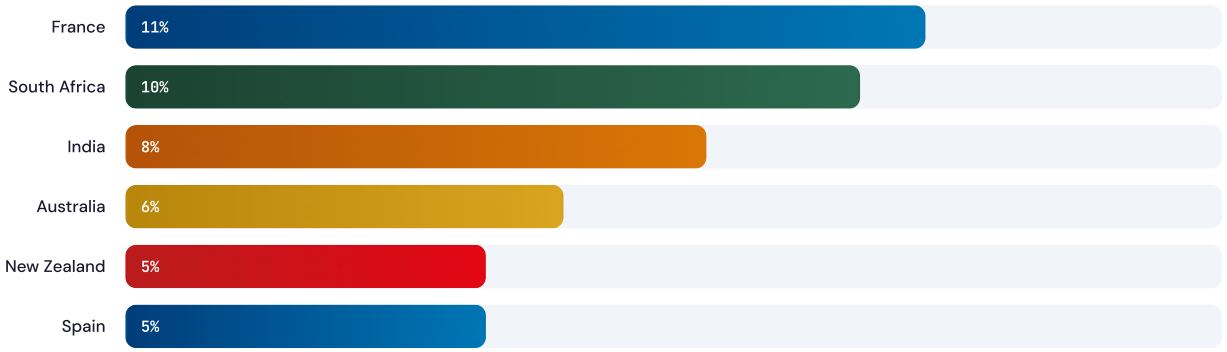
Per Capita Consumption

Annual per capita dairy & eggs consumption (2024), indicating strong baseline demand.

Import Dependency & Supply Chain

METRIC	VALUE	CONTEXT
Local Milk Production	4-5M litres/year	*2-4% of total requirement (IAEA)*
Annual Dairy Import Cost	~Rs 2 billion	*Mauritius Chamber of Agriculture*
Dairy Share of Total Imports	US$124M (1.98%)	*Trend Economy, 2023*
Primary Import Source	NZ & Australia (80%)	*Slow Food*
Total Agricultural Imports (2024)	US$1.6 billion	*24.4% of total imports (Trade.gov)*
CPI Weight: Milk, Cheese & Eggs	29.0 per 1,000	*CEIC Data (2.9% of CPI basket)*

Agricultural Import Sources (2024 Market Share)



Source: US Trade.gov — Mauritius Agricultural Sectors, 2024

Current Retail Dairy Prices (March 2026)

PRODUCT	AVERAGE PRICE (MUR)	RANGE (MUR)
Milk (regular, 1 litre)	Rs 65.71	Rs 50 – 100
Local Cheese (1 kg)	Rs 420.91	Rs 176 – 700
Eggs (12 pack)	Rs 110.13	Rs 60 – 144

Source: Numbeo Cost of Living Index, updated March 2026

PRICE VOLATILITY RISK

The **2x price range** observed across retail channels (e.g., milk at Rs 50–100 per litre) reveals significant pricing inconsistency. With **27 price-controlled products** including powder milk, the government actively monitors prices through the **MOPRI platform** (450+ products, 50+ outlets). For Maurilait, systematic price monitoring ensures compliance, competitive positioning, and margin protection across all channels.

SECTION 04

Maurilait — Company & Brand Portfolio

50 years of market leadership in Mauritius dairy, backed by the Eclosia Group.

Company Profile

Production Capacity

Founded	1976 (50 years)
Parent Group	Eclosia Group
Eclosia Revenue	MUR 20B+ (~US$450M)
Eclosia Employees	5,300+
Eclosia Ranking	Top 5 in Mauritius
Maurilait Employees	225
Product References	150+
Annual Production	18,500 tonnes
Managing Director	Olivier Zuel
HQ	Phoenix, Mauritius
Market Position	Market Leader
Regional Expansion	Madagascar (2020)

Perette Line	70,000 bottles/day
Candia UHT Line	40-60K litres/day
Operating Schedule	6 days/week
Product Categories	142 references
Raw Material Source	Oceania (2,000t/year)

Distribution (via Panagora)

CDP	Corner shops
GMS	Supermarkets
Food Service	Hotels & restaurants

Brand Portfolio

Yoplait
Yogurt — firm, mixed, drinks. International franchise. #2 yogurt brand worldwide.

Candia
UHT Milk. International franchise since 1990s. Core revenue driver.

J (Juice)
Fruit nectar/juice. Launched 2014. First non-dairy product line.

Candia Creme
Cream products. Premium segment extension of the Candia brand.

Miko
Ice cream. International franchise. Seasonal demand peaks.

Perette
Flavoured sterilized milk. Local brand, first in Mauritius.

Dahi
Traditional curdled milk. Indian-heritage inspired local brand.

Greek / Skyr
Premium yogurt lines. Modern, health-conscious product extensions.

SECTION 05

Competitive Landscape

Mapping the competitive forces in the Mauritius dairy and FMCG ecosystem.

COMPANY	TYPE	KEY DETAILS	RELEVANCE
Innodis Ltd	Direct Competitor	Revenue MUR 6B+. 1,400 employees. Serves 5,700+ outlets. DairyVale yogurt, Jump drinking yoghurt, Lait Caille.	High Threat
Grays Inc	FMCG Distributor	Leading importer/distributor. Wide consumer goods range including dairy imports.	Medium
Phoenix Beverages	Beverage	Major beverage company (soft drinks, beer, spirits). Competes in beverage share of stomach.	Medium
Nestlé (imported)	Global Player	Products reach Mauritius through importers. Competes in UHT, infant nutrition, dairy.	Medium
Danone (imported)	Global Player	Imported yogurt and dairy products. Direct category overlap with Yoplait.	High Threat

COMPANY	TYPE	KEY DETAILS	RELEVANCE
Lactalis (imported)	Global Player	World's #1 dairy company ($30.3B). Imports reach Mauritius. Notable: acquiring Yoplait brand globally.	High Threat
Clover Industries	Regional (SA)	South African dairy exports to Mauritius valued at US$3.02M (2022).	Watch

COMPETITIVE INTELLIGENCE GAP

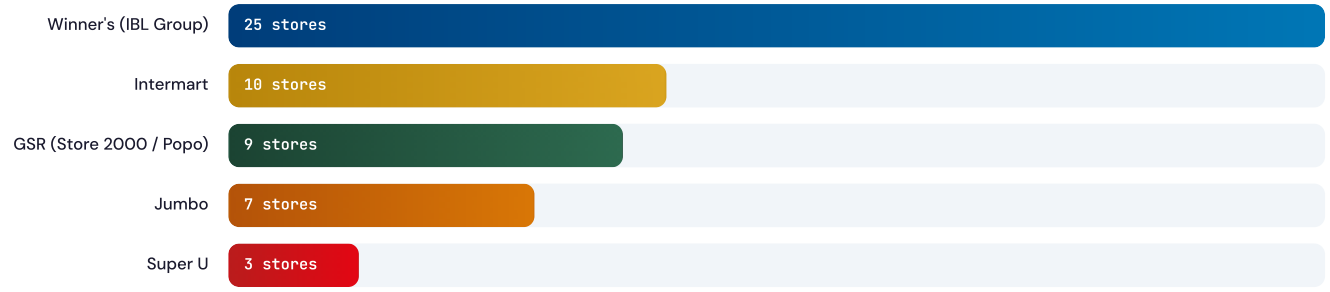
Maurilait faces competition from **Innodis (5,700+ outlets)** domestically and imported brands from **Lactalis (#1 global, $30.3B)**, Danone, and Nestlé. With Lactalis actively integrating Yoplait globally, the competitive dynamics are shifting. Yet most Mauritian dairy companies lack systematic price monitoring across channels — creating a **first-mover advantage** for whoever deploys price intelligence first.

SECTION 06

Retail & Distribution Landscape

The channels through which Maurilait products reach 1.27 million consumers.

Major Retail Chains



Additional chains: London Way, Food Lover's Market, King Savers, Dream Price, Savemart, Lolo

Distribution Structure

Modern Trade	Supermarkets / Hypers
Traditional Trade	Corner shops / Boutiques
Open Markets	Weekly fairs
Distribution Hubs	Port Louis, Plaine Magnien
Delivery Time	Hours to 1 day
Island Area	2,040 km²

Price Control Framework

Controlled Products	27 items
Includes Powder Milk	Yes
Govt Monitoring App	MOPRI
Products Tracked	450+
Outlets Monitored	50+
Regulatory Body	Min. of Commerce

SECTION 07

Global Dairy Market & Pricing Trends

A US$1 trillion global market experiencing unprecedented price volatility.

US$1.02T

Global Dairy Market (2025)

Growing at 4.75% CAGR. Projected to reach US$1.49 trillion by 2033.

21%

FAO Price Swing

FAO Dairy Price Index swung from 153.5 (May 2025) to 120.9 (March 2026) — 21% decline in under a year.

US$23.2B

Middle East & Africa Dairy (2025)

Growing at 5.50% CAGR to US$39.6B by 2035. Africa projected at 76M tonnes by 2035.

FAO Dairy Price Index Timeline

December 2024

Index at 138.9 — Up 17% Year-on-Year

Strong recovery in global dairy prices driven by tight supply. Butter reaches record highs.

May 2025 — PEAK

Index Hits 153.5 — Up 21.5% YoY

Peak prices driven by tight global supplies, strong demand, and cheese price surges. Maximum cost pressure on importers like Maurilait.

2025 Full Year Average

Index Averages 146.9 — Up 13.2% vs 2024

Sustained elevation. Despite late-year easing, 2025 was a significantly more expensive year for dairy procurement globally.

March 2026

Index at 120.9 — Down 18.7% YoY

Sharp correction. Global production reaches 992.7M tonnes. Prices normalize but remain volatile. Import cost relief for Mauritius.

Global Dairy Top 10 Companies (2025, Rabobank)

RANK	COMPANY	COUNTRY	REVENUE (USD B)
1	**Lactalis**	France	$30.3
2	**Nestlé**	Switzerland	$25.0
3	**Dairy Farmers of America**	USA	$24.8
4	**Danone**	France	$19.4
5	**Yili**	China	$18.5
6	**Fonterra**	New Zealand	$17.6
7	**FrieslandCampina**	Netherlands	$14.0
8	**Arla Foods**	Denmark/Sweden	$13.9
9	**Mengniu**	China	$12.1
10	**Saputo**	Canada	$11.8

Source: Rabobank Global Dairy Top 20 via Dairy Dimension. Note: Lactalis crossed $30B for the first time. Yoplait integration into Lactalis/Sodiaal expected in 2026.

Digital Transformation & E-Commerce in Mauritius

Africa's #1 e-commerce-ready nation with 168% mobile penetration and rapidly growing digital payments.

#1

E-Commerce Readiness in Africa

Mauritius ranks 1st in Sub-Saharan Africa and 55th globally on UNCTAD B2C E-commerce Index (score: 68.4%).

168%

Mobile Penetration

2.14 million connections for 1.27M people. 95.8% broadband (3G/4G/5G). 88.6% of households have smartphones.

94.3%

Facebook Dominance

859,000 users (67.7% of population). Facebook utterly dominates social media and commerce channels in Mauritius.

Digital Infrastructure

Internet Penetration	79.5%
Social Media Users	859,000
Instagram Users	399,000
LinkedIn Users	570,000
Median Download Speed	51.71 Mbps
E-Commerce Revenue (2025)	US$35.8M
E-Commerce CAGR	8.9%
E-Commerce User Penetration	21.9%

Digital Payments & Grocery

Grocery Delivery Revenue (2024)	US$63.6M
Grocery Delivery CAGR	17.98%
Grocery by 2029	US$145.3M
Digital Payments by 2029	US$3.84B
Digital Payments Growth	▲21.17% CAGR
Payment Backbone	MauCAS (BoM)
Contactless Payments	45%+
Key Wallets	Juice, Orange Money

Online Grocery Platforms in Mauritius

PLATFORM	DESCRIPTION	COVERAGE
Votre Pote Age	"#1 online supermarket" — 24hr delivery	Island-wide
Winner's Online	Click-and-collect + home delivery	Island-wide
Mycart.mu	Multi-vendor marketplace	Mauritius & Rodrigues
eShops.mu	Digital mall aggregator	Home delivery
Scott Home Delivery	Premium groceries & wines	Island-wide
PriceGuru.mu	Price comparison (electronics/general)	Online

DIGITAL COMMERCE OPPORTUNITY

With **88.6% smartphone penetration**, **grocery delivery growing at 18% CAGR**, and **digital payments projected at US$3.84B by 2029**, the Mauritius market is rapidly digitalizing. Price Pulse is positioned at the intersection of this digital transformation — giving Maurilait real-time visibility into an increasingly complex omnichannel landscape where prices can vary 2x between outlets.

Price Intelligence Technology

The global market for price monitoring software is booming — and for good reason.

16.2%

CAGR of Price Intelligence Software

Market growing from US$1.41B (2024) to US$4.28B by 2033. Asia-Pacific fastest at 18.5% CAGR.

10-100x

Typical ROI

Companies deploying price intelligence tools report 10x to 100x return on investment.

88%

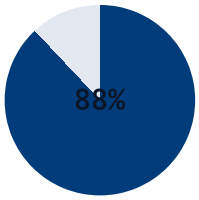
CPG Firms Budgeting for AI

66% already deploying generative AI. Companies that adopt AI see 30% marketing ROI improvement and 65% forecasting error reduction.

The Business Case for Price Intelligence

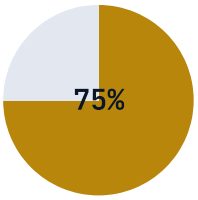
METRIC	IMPACT	SOURCE
1% Price Improvement	▲11% margin improvement	*FP&A Professionals*
Digital Tool Adoption	▲23% more profitable	*SoftServe*
Revenue Growth with RGM	▲5-10% annually	*Catena Solutions*
AI Forecasting Error Reduction	▲-65% error	*AppInventiv*
AI Marketing ROI	▲+30% improvement	*AppInventiv*
Inventory Error Reduction	▲Up to -50%	*RedCloud Technology*
Trade Promotions Failing ROI	▼72% of all trade spend	*NielsenIQ*
Market Share at Risk for Slow Adopters	▼10-15% loss by 2030	*TTMS*
Products Out of Stock at Any Time	▼Up to 10%	*RedCloud Technology*
Modern Price Collection Speed	2 seconds/product	*Optimix*

AI & Digital Transformation in FMCG



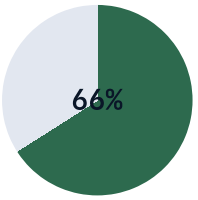
CPG Firms Budgeting for AI

Actively investing



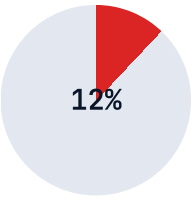
Cite Digital as Top Priority

FMCG companies



Already Deploying Gen AI

CPG firms globally



Achieve Full Tech ROI

First-mover advantage critical

Sources: CIO Inc, RedCloud Technology, SoftServe, TTMS

THE AI IMPERATIVE

The global AI in consumer goods market is exploding from **$3.1B to $37.3B** (31.8% CAGR). While 88% of CPG firms are budgeting for AI, only **12% achieve full ROI**. This creates a massive first-mover advantage: companies that deploy intelligent price monitoring now will capture the efficiency gains while competitors still struggle with manual processes. For Maurilait, Price Pulse represents this first-mover opportunity in the Mauritius market.

SECTION 10

The Strategic Case for Price Pulse

Why real-time price intelligence is not optional for Mauritius' market leader.

The Problem

- 96-98% import dependency exposes to global commodity price swings
- 30% rupee depreciation since 2020 amplifies import costs
- 2x price variation between outlets (Rs 50-100 for 1L milk)
- 27 price-controlled products requiring compliance monitoring
- 72% of trade promotions fail to return on investment globally
- Innodis serves 5,700+ outlets — visibility is a competitive weapon
- Lactalis ($30.3B) integrating Yoplait globally — pricing pressure incoming

The Solution: Price Pulse

- Panel-based pricing audit across all 12 districts, 5 outlet types
- Consistent audit panel of 40 outlets for month-on-month statistical validity
- Automated competitor price intelligence with % change arrows (Innodis, imports)
- 4 brand portfolios audited: Yoplait, Candia, J, Candia Creme + 12 competitor products
- Price anomaly detection and compliance alerts
- Regional heatmaps showing pricing disparities by district
- Field audit network: 24+ trained staff across Mauritius
- Weekly audit cycle with Week 4 dashboard access

Expected Impact

+11%
Margin Improvement
From just 1% price optimization across 150+ SKUs.

100%
Price Compliance
Real-time monitoring of 27 controlled products.

12
Districts Covered
Island-wide visibility into every pricing zone.

2s
Per-Product Collection
Modern mobile data capture in the field.

THE EXOTICA ADVANTAGE

Unlike international price monitoring platforms that cost **$50,000-$500,000/year** and lack Mauritius-specific coverage, Exotica combines **local field teams in all 12 districts** with **custom-built analytics technology**. The result: comprehensive price intelligence at a fraction of international pricing, with the depth that only local knowledge can provide. **Price Pulse** is built for Mauritius, by Mauritius.

SECTION 11

Pricing Audit Methodology & Framework

A structured, panel-based audit approach modelled on Nielsen Retail Measurement Services — ensuring statistical rigour, month-on-month comparability, and actionable intelligence.

Panel-Based vs Census Approach

Methodology	Fixed Panel
Industry Standard	Nielsen RMS
Key Advantage	Month-on-month comparability
Panel Size	40 fixed outlets
Rotating Sample	Additional outlets for validation
Statistical Basis	Consistent measurement points eliminate sampling noise

Audit Panel Design

Outlet Types Covered	All 5 types
Districts Covered	All 12
Weighting	By population & retail density
Urban/Rural Mix	Proportional
Outlet Selection	Stratified random sampling
Replacement Protocol	Like-for-like substitution

Weekly Audit Cadence

Week 1

Audit Planning & SKU Selection

Define target SKUs for the cycle based on competitive signals from previous audit. Confirm panel outlets across all 12 districts. Brief field audit teams on focus areas and any special collection requirements. Select priority categories for deeper competitive analysis.

Week 2 - 3

Field Data Collection

Trained field auditors visit the same panel outlets every cycle. Prices recorded via mobile application with photo-verified price tags. Real-time GPS validation confirms auditor presence at panel outlets. Automated outlier flagging catches data entry errors in-field. Coverage spans all 5 outlet types: supermarkets, hypermarkets, corner shops, convenience stores, and wholesalers.

Week 4

Dashboard Goes Live

Price Pulse dashboard updated with latest audit data. Interactive competitor % comparisons with visual up/down arrows. Regional heatmaps, brand trend lines, and anomaly alerts all refresh simultaneously. Client team accesses results in real-time via the Price Pulse portal — no waiting for static reports.

Quality Assurance Framework

QA LAYER	METHOD	TIMING
Photo Verification	Mandatory price tag photos for every recorded price	In-field
GPS Validation	Automated location confirmation at each panel outlet	In-field
Outlier Detection	Statistical flagging of prices outside 2 standard deviations	Automated
Cross-Outlet Check	Same product price compared across outlets for consistency	Processing
Month-on-Month Delta	Changes exceeding 10% flagged for manual review	Processing
Panel Compliance	Track % of panel outlets successfully audited per cycle	Reporting

Audit Data Outputs

% Δ

Price Change vs Prior Period

Month-on-month and quarter-on-quarter price movements for every SKU, brand, region, and

vs Comp

Competitor Gap Analysis

Percentage gap between Maurilait pricing and each competitor, with directional arrows showing

RDI

Regional Disparity Index

Coefficient of variation across 12 districts, identifying regions where pricing is out of line

outlet type.

whether the gap is widening or narrowing.

with national averages.

WHY PANEL-BASED AUDITING WORKS

The global price intelligence industry (valued at **US$1.41 billion**) is built on a fundamental principle: **consistency of measurement beats breadth of coverage**. Nielsen, the world's largest retail measurement company, built its entire methodology on fixed panels. By auditing the **same 40 outlets every month**, Exotica eliminates sampling noise and delivers data that Maurilait can confidently use for pricing decisions. A 1% price improvement from this intelligence translates to an **11% margin improvement** across the portfolio.

SECTION 12

About Exotica Agency

Founded in Mauritius — deep local market knowledge, on-ground brand activation, and data-driven research.

Irfaan Mooradun

Director, Client Relations

5+ years in FMCG brand strategy and activation. Mauritius-based with deep relationships across the retail and distribution ecosystem.

Ernest Moyo

Research, Technology & Data Science

Platform development, data science, analytics infrastructure & AI. Builds the technology backbone that powers Price Pulse.

Core Capabilities

Local Presence	All 12 districts
Field Researchers	24+ trained staff
Data Collection	Mobile, real-time
Dashboards	Custom analytics
Turnaround	Monthly guaranteed

Core Values

Professionalism	✓
Communication	✓
Excellence	✓
Results-Driven	✓
Cost-Effective	✓

SECTION 13

Sources & Methodology

This report draws on 100+ verified data points from authoritative primary and secondary sources.

International Organizations

- FAO — Dairy Price Index, Food Price Monitoring
- IMF — Mauritius Article IV Consultation 2025
- World Bank — GDP & Development Indicators
- UNCTAD — B2C E-Commerce Index

Industry & Market Data

- Rabobank — Global Dairy Top 20 (2025)
- Statista — Market forecasts & consumer data
- Trading Economics — Inflation & price data
- IMARC Group — Global dairy market sizing

IAEA — Mauritius Local Feed Production

AfDB — Mauritius Economic Outlook

Dataintelo — Price intelligence software market

NielsenIQ — Trade promotion analytics

Government & Regulatory

Statistics Mauritius — CPI, HBS 2023

US Trade.gov — Mauritius Country Commercial Guide

MOPRI — Government Price Observatory

CEIC Data — CPI weights

Mauritius Chamber of Agriculture

Ministry of Commerce — Acts & Regulations

Corporate & Digital

Eclosia Group — Maurilait corporate profile

Innodis Group — Competitor analysis

DataReportal — Digital 2025 Mauritius

Numbeo — Cost of Living Index

Platform Africa — Industry reporting

MCCI — Trade agreements & consumer law

METHODOLOGY

Data collected April 2026 from publicly available sources including government statistical offices, international organization databases, industry research reports, corporate filings, market data platforms, and digital analytics tools. All figures represent the most recent available data at time of publication. Price data in MUR (Mauritian Rupee) unless otherwise stated.

EXOTICA

Market intelligence and brand activation agency. Founded in Mauritius with deep local knowledge and on-ground expertise across all 12 districts.

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DELIVERABLES

This Research Document
Price Pulse Platform (Live)
Strategic Pitch Deck

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Know your prices. Own your market.